

H *Mr. Milch,*

Now, is it your theory that Professor Krauch's title of Plenipotentiary meant nothing whatsoever?

I regard a title of that sort as purely an outward affair. Everybody is fond of titles in Europe.

Now, is it your theory that this circular letter of Goering's (ordering the Ministries to accomplish the Krauch production-plan), was not to be taken seriously?

You must have misunderstood me. All I say is that Goering interfered to a large extent with the other ministries.

Now, of course, I wouldn't like to argue, but is it known to you, witness, that Goering, in his capacity as Commissioner of the Four Year Plan, could give orders to all Reich Ministries?

I know. In theory it was pure wine, but you had to pour a lot of water on it in actual fact. Even a man like Goering was in no position to carry the day one hundred percent in the way he wanted to. The other ministers who felt their toes stepped on still could go and see Hitler.

((SIX SPACES))

Buna rubber, stretching back through five years, finally gummed his lips. He, too, had dreamed of a Volkswagon in every garage. He'd wanted mass-production of buna in late 1935, when he took of Goering's "Raw Materials" staff, the predecessors of the Four-Year Plan. Then he had run into trouble with the Reich Ministry of Economics.

It was a crazy set-up, reminiscent of the early New Deal. He could plan for mass-production, but he had no authority to carry out the plan. Production itself was under a General Loeb. "Loeb was a very difficult man," ter Meer had pointed out, and Loeb's own office records proved it. War-production was controlled by the Ministry of Economics, but Loeb, though a General stationed in that agency, believed that war-production should be secondary.

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